

Project Scout

Quick Start

Last updated: June 7, 2026

Upload this at the start of EVERY Claude or ChatGPT session about Scout. For full technical details, use the Scout Master Summary (v19).

June 7, 2026 — What Is New:

- TinyLlama crash on Galaxy A32 stabilized.
 - Identity routing expanded: chatbot, feelings, creator, and current activity responses.
 - Thinking-state gaze stabilization added.
 - Creator memory is the next major task — CREATOR fact slot planned.
 - Face evolution direction locked: eyes, eyelids, eyebrows, blink timing — one safe step at a time.
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1. Who Is Patrick

Patrick Lippy — creator and developer of Scout. NOT a professional programmer. Stroke survivor, dyslexic, blind in right eye, type 1 diabetic.

- Explain everything at screenshot level. Keep messages clear and not visually overwhelming.
 - Always provide full paste-ready files, one at a time — or exact CTRL-F / CTRL-R surgical edits. No snippets. No partial files.
 - Wife: Diana | Son: Elijah (age 9, Scout's biggest fan) | Dog: Nicolas
 - **Names must NEVER be hardcoded in Scout's code. Always use variables.**
 - Both Claude and ChatGPT are active collaborators. Cross-review between them is welcome.
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2. What Scout Is

Scout is a calm family companion robot running on a Samsung Galaxy phone mounted in landscape mode as a permanent face display. Scout has animated eyes, speaks, listens, sees via camera, and remembers the family.

- Package: com.example.scoutface | Language: Kotlin + C++ NDK
 - Primary test device: Samsung Galaxy A32 (stress-test, not the benchmark)
 - Dev device: Samsung Galaxy Fold 7 (wireless via WiFi)
 - App: \$9.99 one-time purchase on Google Play. No subscriptions. Ever.
 - Brains: TinyLlama 1.1B (offline, always included) + user's own free Gemini key (online, optional)
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3. Scout's Core Philosophy

Scout should feel: Calm. Thoughtful. Quietly alive. Emotionally subtle. Occasionally curious.

Scout should NOT feel: Excited. Scripted. Fake. Cartoonish. Hyperactive. Constantly praising.

Stability > Features | Presence > Intelligence | Honest > Fake cheerful | Local-first > Cloud | Predictable > Flashy

4. What Is Working Right Now

- ✓ Animated face (ScoutFaceView) — custom Canvas animation
 - ✓ Speech recognition (STT) + Text-to-Speech (TTS)
 - ✓ Camera — face detection, scene labeling (ML Kit)
 - ✓ Gemini API integration (online brain, user's own key)
 - ✓ Memory layers: TruthDb, HabitLayer, PeopleDb, JournalDb, ConversationDb
 - ✓ Intent router — weather, time, greetings, family facts, downloads, IDENTITY
 - ✓ TinyLlama 1.1B offline brain — VERIFIED on BOTH A32 and Fold 7
 - ✓ TinyLlama crash on A32 stabilized (NEW — June 7)
 - ✓ Weather via Open-Meteo — precipitation %, offline-aware
 - ✓ Identity questions hardcoded: are you my friend / can you hear me / are you happy (June 5)
 - ✓ Identity routing expanded: chatbot / feelings / creator / current activity (NEW — June 7)
 - ✓ Total offline mode — 'go offline' blocks ALL internet features (June 5)
 - ✓ Thinking-state gaze stabilization (NEW — June 7)
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5. Known Issues — Do Not Touch Without Discussion

- **Iris jitter in ScoutFaceView**— A32 only (hardware-related). Fold 7 unaffected. Needs dedicated visual session.
 - **STT name recognition**— 'Scout' misheard as 'Gal', 'Scott', 'Out'. STT/phonetic issue, not TinyLlama. Separate session.
 - **Live news**— neither Gemini nor TinyLlama reads live news. A future news feed is needed. Offline, Scout returns old frozen training-data news.
 - **Barge-in**— deliberately disabled. PARKED. Do not reactivate without a full dedicated session.
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Current Priority — Update As Goals Shift

1. ScoutFaceView session — iris jitter (A32), wire in mood system
 2. Creator memory — implement CREATOR fact slot in TruthDb (NEXT MAJOR TASK)
 3. STT phonetic matching for wake word 'Scout' — separate session
 4. Downloads should respect 'go offline' (finish total-offline mode)
 5. Response cleanup layer — post-TinyLlama filter (safety + identity + honest news handling)
 6. Scout news feed — FUTURE feature, same clean pattern as weather
 7. MainActivity cleanup and shortening — ongoing
 8. Offline Brain Phase 3 — Google Play Asset Delivery
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6. Working Rules — Always Apply

- Full paste-ready files only, one at a time. No snippets. No partial files.
- Surgical CTRL-F / CTRL-R edits for large files — always specify which file tab to click first.

- Some Scout files have NO indentation (flush-left). If a search fails, try a shorter unique single-line search.
- One safe change at a time. Build and test before the next change.
- Never touch speech, camera, or download systems without explicit discussion.
- Never touch ScoutFaceView casually — it is Scout's visual heart.
- Patrick is not a professional programmer — screenshot-level explanations always.

This Quick Start is the session-opener. For full architecture, NDK discoveries, business decisions, and technical reference — upload the Scout Master Summary (v19).